

the best thing is that it's integrated throughout Mac OS X. Just enter all the information once, and you can access it from Mail, iChat or any other third-party applications. You can import contacts, create distribution lists and labels for clubs and groups, print address labels, cards and envelopes, and do a lot more. You can also sync the contact information on your Mac with your iPhone or other mobile phone, PDA, or MobileMe, so that your Address Book follows you everywhere.

Automator

Automator is a work-flow tool for automating tedious, repetitive manual tasks such as resizing a collection of photos, converting file types, combining text files, syncing files between folders, and so on and getting them done quickly, efficiently and effortlessly. Just about anything that you can do with your Mac, you can automate. It comes with a bevy of useful scripts already installed. But what's even better is that you can create your own Automator actions without any complex programming or scripting. Just assemble individual steps into a complete task by dragging these actions into an Automator workflow or use the Watch Me Do action that lets you record an action such as pressing a button or controlling an application without inbuilt Automator support and replaying it as an action in a workflow. If you still cannot get your way through, there's a good chance that an Automator script for the task you're trying to complete already exists on the web. Check out <http://www.apple.com/downloads/macosx/automator> for lots of premade example.

Calculator

The Calculator application in Mac OS X allows you to perform simple arithmetic calculations, numerical comparisons, complex logarithmic calculations, and logical operations. It comes with three modes: basic, programmer, and scientific. You can review a history of your calculations as a running record and print them with the Print Tape feature ([**command**] + [**T**]). Calculator also includes a built-in unit converter for converting common units of measure like area, length, and volume and currency. It even talks in the sense that it can read out both button presses and the results if you want it to by using the Speech drop-down menu.

Another cool feature in the Mac, Spotlight, has the functions of a basic math calculator. Just type the equation into Spotlight, select it and it'll solve it for you.